



KPO

Gurgaon | HARYANA

Don't call back

No longer limited to call centre work, the BPO industry is becoming the high-end back office of the world

■ By Nandini Vaish

It's not a call centre, but a BPO company where I work," says Prashant Sharma. This is something that the 24-year-old employee of IBM Daksh often has to clarify when he meets many of his parents' friends. The fact is that even though the Indian business process outsourcing (BPO) industry is \$6.3

billion today, most people still associate it with call centres and customer care. While that continues to represent 35 per cent of the total back-office business, call centres are becoming less important—in 2000, they represented 85 per cent of the total business—with more and more big outsourcing firms beginning to turn down call centre jobs, preferring better-paying contracts for handling insurance claims, processing mortgages and doing budget forecasting for companies.

"The Indian BPO industry has become much more sophisticated", says Neeraj Bhargava, Group CEO, WNS Global Services. Adds Pavan Vaish, chief executive officer, IBM Daksh, "Today, we are providing support to CEOs of Fortune 500 companies in taking crucial decisions related to budget forecasting and capital expenditure." Now, 40 per cent of the company's revenues come from high-end work, which is why today BPOs would rather be called KPOs (knowledge process outsourcing). But more importantly,

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